

Section 3 — Design Tokens

STATUS: APPROVED

Purpose

This section defines the shared design tokens that create visual consistency across the entire CLA website.

All components should use the same centralized design tokens to ensure consistency, maintainability, and scalability.

Centralized Design Tokens

All design tokens are maintained in one centralized designTokens file.

This includes:

- * Colors
- * Typography
- * Spacing
- * Radius
- * Shadows
- * Motion
- * Breakpoints
- * Shared visual constants

Components should reference these tokens rather than defining their own values.

Token Naming

Design tokens use semantic names rather than value-based names.

Examples:

- * primaryColor
- * secondaryColor
- * backgroundSurface
- * textPrimary
- * spacingLarge
- * borderRadiusLarge

Semantic naming allows the design system to evolve without changing component code.

Spacing System

The website uses one standardized spacing scale.

Approved spacing values:

- * 4
- * 8
- * 12
- * 16
- * 24
- * 32
- * 48
- * 64
- * 96
- * 128

Arbitrary spacing values should be avoided whenever practical.

Radius Tokens

Only the official radius values defined in the CLA Brand & Design Language OS may be used.

No additional radius values should be introduced without approval.

Shadow Tokens

All components use the official shadow tokens defined in the CLA Brand & Design Language OS.

Custom shadows should not be introduced outside the approved system.

Typography Tokens

Typography is centralized.

The design token system defines:

- * Font families
- * Font sizes
- * Font weights
- * Line heights
- * Letter spacing

Components should not create independent typography systems.

Breakpoints

The website uses one centralized responsive breakpoint system.

All components should reference the same breakpoint definitions to ensure consistent responsive behavior.

Motion Tokens

Animation values are centralized.

This includes:

- * Durations
- * Easing curves
- * Timing values
- * Transition speeds

Components should not introduce independent animation timing.

Z-Index

Components may define their own z-index values when appropriate.

They should remain organized, predictable, and avoid conflicts with other components.

Color Usage

Components use only colors defined within the centralized design token system.

Independent color definitions should be avoided.

Guiding Principle

One source of truth creates one consistent experience.

End of Section 3